

NEOLABS

SECURITY LABS | SOC LEVEL 1

Week 1 Launch Pack — Operation Night Watch

Weekly Learning Pack | Learn + Connect + Operate

Programme: NeoLabs x Renaissance Innovation Labs Cybersecurity Internship

Week 01

Version: 1.0

Classification: Student Training Material

Authorised synthetic training use only.

Your objective

Build a defensible picture of **normal** VCC activity in your assigned pod. This baseline becomes the comparison point for later security incidents.

Start in this order

- 1 Clone this SOC toolkit repository.
- 2 In the repository folder install the NeoLabs CLI:

```
python -m pip install -e .
```

- 1 Prepare the local Wazuh stack using `wazuh-stack/README.md` and its preflight steps.
- 2 Set the NeoLabs lab gateway URL supplied in your onboarding message.
- 3 Authenticate:

```
neolabs login
```

Enter **only your assigned pod number** and your private NeoLabs Access Code.

- 1 Verify your assignment:

```
neolabs status  
neolabs pod info
```

- 1 Connect:

```
neolabs connect
```

When the lab is LIVE this enrolls your local Wazuh through the pod-scoped mTLS channel. During REPLAY windows the same command loads only your authorised archived telemetry into the local Wazuh data path.

What to study before the task

Use the material in `publications/` in this order:

- 1 **Log Literacy for Cybersecurity Analysts** — how to read and correlate security telemetry.
- 2 **SecOps Foundations / Field Guide** — evidence-first analyst workflow and escalation.
- 3 **SOC L1 Analyst Handbook** — deeper reference.
- 4 **Wazuh Deployment and Investigation Guide** — setup, dashboard workflow and troubleshooting.
- 5 **SOC L1 Complete Toolkit** — long-form reference; you do not need to read it cover-to-cover before Week 1.

Week 1 task

- 1 Verify that the supplied synthetic verification event appears in Wazuh with the correct pod and scenario context.
- 2 Identify at least one normal successful sign-in and an ordinary failed sign-in if present.
- 3 Identify normal application/API activity and record useful fields such as timestamp, synthetic identity, request/event type, result/status and request/correlation identifier where available.
- 4 Identify storage or other approved telemetry visible for your pod.

- 5 Create and save at least **three reusable baseline searches/filters**.
- 6 Build a short normal-activity timeline using at least two event types.
- 7 Record one visibility gap: a question the current telemetry cannot answer and what additional source/field would help.
- 8 Do **not** label activity malicious simply because it looks unusual. Week 1 is the reference baseline.

Deliverables

- `baseline-log-report.md`
- `timeline.md`
- `evidence-log.md`
- `query-journal.md`
- redacted screenshots where useful

Baseline report headings

- Scope and assigned pod
- Sources visible in Wazuh
- Normal authentication pattern
- Normal application/API pattern
- Normal storage/other telemetry
- Three saved baseline queries
- Visibility gaps and limitations
- What you would compare against during a future incident

Evidence standard

- Use event time, not only ingestion/replay time.
- Preserve request/event IDs where available.
- Separate observed facts from interpretation.
- Redact Access Codes, tokens, private keys and personal data.
- Never include another pod's data in your report.

Stop conditions

Stop and contact a mentor if you receive another pod's events, real personal information, a private credential, unexpected infrastructure access or service instability.

Before submission

- `[ ] neolabs status` shows the correct pod, track and Week 1 scenario.

- ☐ Wazuh is healthy.
- ☐ Three baseline queries are recorded.
- ☐ Timeline uses at least two event types.
- ☐ Evidence references are reproducible.
- ☐ Screenshots are redacted.
- ☐ Conclusions are supported by evidence.